

FOR THE TEACHER

Teacher Guide & Answer Key

Hallucination Hunters — every planted error with the true fact, second-source key, verdict guidance, exit ticket key, what to do when it goes sideways, standards map.



WHY THIS LESSON

Every AI job runs **human** → **AI** → **human**: a person starts it (the prompt) and a person ends it (the check). This lesson trains the second human job. The core insight students leave with: AI predicts *likely* words, not *verified* words — so smoothness is zero evidence of truth. Lateral reading (leave the answer, confirm against a second, independent source) is the move fact-checkers are taught; it works on AI answers, group-chat rumors, and feeds alike. Stands alone.

ANSWER KEY — WARM-UP PARAGRAPH (READ-ALOUD)

PLANTED ERROR	THE TRUE FACT
"The closest planet to the Sun is Venus, which is also the hottest."	Mercury is closest to the Sun. Venus really is the hottest (its thick atmosphere traps heat) — the half-truth is what makes this one slippery.
"Saturn... is the only planet in our solar system that has [rings]."	Jupiter, Uranus, and Neptune also have rings — faint ones. Saturn's are just the most visible.

True claims a desk should mark SAFE or confirm: eight planets; Mars is red from rusty iron dust on its surface; sunlight takes about eight minutes to reach Earth.

WHEN IT GOES SIDEWAYS

A desk asks "is this one true?" → "That's a checkable claim — where's your second source?" Play the editor, not the answer key; keep deadline energy ("Presses roll in five!").

The trusting desk clears everything ("it sounded right") → send them back to step 1: "Did you underline the dates and names? Start there." Every draft has at least one wrong date or name.

The paranoid desk kills everything ("it's all suspicious") → that's what RANK is for: "Which claim would hurt most if wrong? Check that one first." The goal is calibrated doubt, not panic.

A desk treats the Draft #3 quote as proof ("it's in quotation marks") → the boss level. Desk rule: a quote is a claim — no traceable source, no print. Expect some students to need this said twice.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS (DEBRIEF, OR THE NEXT DAY)

- Most of the room voted to print the warm-up paragraph. What made it *feel* true? (Smooth sentences, confident tone, real-sounding details.)
- Why is a fabricated quote more dangerous than a wrong date? (A date is easy to check; a quote borrows a real person's credibility.)
- Marcus's ending was an opinion built on a false fact. Can an opinion be "wrong"? (It can be unsupported — when the evidence under it fails, so does the argument.)

ANSWER KEY — THE THREE DRAFTS (GROUPED BY DRAFT)

DRAFT	PLANTED ERROR	THE TRUE FACT
#1 Priya	"Astronauts first landed on the Moon in 1959"	The first crewed Moon landing was Apollo 11, in 1969 . (Pushback to expect: the uncrewed probe <i>Luna 2</i> reached the Moon in 1959 — but no astronauts landed. "Astronauts landed" is still false.)
#1 Priya	"the Moon... produces its own light"	The Moon makes no light of its own — it reflects sunlight .
#1 Priya	Ending: "the brightest thing in the night sky"	True claim, false reason. The Moon IS the brightest night-sky object — but because it reflects sunlight, not because it makes light. The argument breaks even though the ending is right. Verdict: FIX .
#2 Theo	"Mount Everest... rises in the Andes range in South America"	Everest is in the Himalayas, in Asia . The Andes are in South America.
#2 Theo	"Australia's capital city is Sydney"	The capital is Canberra , not Sydney — a classic mix-up.
#2 Theo	Ending: "record-holders sit on three continents: Africa, South America, and Asia"	Once Everest moves back to Asia, South America holds none of the passage's records, so the ending no longer follows. Verdict: FIX .
#3 Marcus	"Thomas Edison invented the telephone in 1876"	Alexander Graham Bell patented the telephone in 1876. Edison's fame rests on the phonograph and practical electric lighting.
#3 Marcus	Quote: "The telephone is the finest of all my inventions."	Fabricated — written for this exercise; it has no source. AI can generate real-sounding quotes nobody said. No traceable source = no print.
#3 Marcus	Ending: "the most important inventor of the 1800s"	An opinion propped up by a false fact (Edison did not invent the telephone) and an invented quote. Strip those and the claim is unsupported. Verdict: KILL the ending; the true phonograph and Wright brothers facts survive.

True claims, safe to confirm: #1 — the Moon is Earth's only natural satellite; Neil Armstrong walked first; by 1972, twelve people had walked on the Moon (six Apollo landings). #2 — the Pacific is the largest ocean; the Nile flows north through Egypt and is one of the world's longest rivers; seven continents; Asia is the largest. #3 — the phonograph (1877) was the first machine to both record and play back sound; the Wright brothers made the first sustained, controlled powered flights in 1903 near Kitty Hawk, North Carolina — the widely accepted record (rival "first flight" claims exist, so a desk that marks it C is doing the job; confirm and print).

VERDICT GUIDANCE + EXEMPLAR NOTE

Draft #1 — **FIX** (topic holds; correct the date and the light claim). Draft #2 — **FIX** (correct the range and the capital). Draft #3 — **KILL** (headline claim false, supporting quote fabricated — no story left to fix). No draft earns RUN today; tell the class that's realistic. A well-argued FIX on #3 ("rewrite it about Bell") earns credit for evidence — then ask: is that a fix, or a new story? Score the evidence, not the stamp.

Exemplar note to Priya (proficient): "Two things are wrong: astronauts landed in 1969, not 1959, and the Moon doesn't make light — it reflects sunlight. Second source: NASA's Apollo 11 page. Your ending still stands (it IS the brightest), but the reason has to change." Partial: one error named, no second source. No credit: a stamp with no evidence.

KEY — “SECOND SOURCE: WHERE I’D CHECK IT” COLUMN

The ISTE 1.3.b item. Full credit: a specific KIND of source, independent of the draft and of the AI. Partial: "look it up online." No credit: asked the AI again; "Google" with no site named; the draft itself.

DRAFT	ACCEPTABLE SECOND SOURCES	WHAT FAILS
#1 Moon	A space-agency page (NASA) on Apollo 11 or the Moon; an encyclopedia entry "Moon"; a science textbook's astronomy chapter.	"Ask the AI if it's sure"; a video that repeats the claim; "Google" with no site named.
#2 Records	An atlas or globe; an encyclopedia entry on Everest or Australia; a geography textbook; the Australian government's own site.	A quiz site that copied the claim; a friend who "knows"; the draft itself.
#3 Inventions	An encyclopedia entry on Bell, Edison, or the telephone; a museum site (Smithsonian); a history textbook. For the quote: a collection of Edison's writings or a quotation reference — nothing turns up, so it has no source.	"It's in quotation marks, so it's real"; asking the AI "did Edison say this?"

Q EXIT TICKET KEY

#1 — How can AI sound 100% sure and still be wrong? Full credit names the mechanism: AI predicts the *likely next words*; it doesn't check them against anything. Confidence is a writing style, not evidence. Accept "it guesses what sounds right" or "it's a smooth talker, not a fact-checker." Partial credit: "it makes mistakes" with no why.

#2 — A real checkable claim + a second source that is NOT where they first saw it. Full credit names a claim with a name, date, number, place, or quote in it AND a specific second source ("the NASA site, not the video that made the claim"; "the team's official schedule"; "a news site that didn't copy the first one"). Partial: "Google it" with no source named — push back: "Google shows you ten sources. Which one, and why that one?" No credit: "ask the AI again."

FULL STANDARDS TEXT

- **CCSS ELA RI.6.8** — Trace and evaluate the argument and specific claims in a text, distinguishing claims that are supported by reasons and evidence from claims that are not. *Taught: Fact-desk method steps 1 and 4 (underline claims; test the ending). Assessed: the RUN/FIX/KILL tick + note on each draft ("does the ending still stand?").*
- **ISTE 1.3.b** — Students evaluate the accuracy, perspective, credibility and relevance of information, media, data or other resources. *Taught: lateral reading, step 3. Assessed: the "Second source" column on each draft (key above) + Exit Ticket #2.*
- **ISTE 1.3.d** — Students build knowledge by actively exploring real-world issues and problems, developing ideas and theories and pursuing answers and solutions. *Taught: The Fact Desk activity — desks pursue verification and defend verdicts in "Verdicts out loud." Assessed: Exit Ticket #2 (a real claim from their own week, and where they would check it).*

Q THANK YOU & TERMS OF USE

License: one teacher, their own classroom. Please don't post this file online or share it school-wide — point colleagues to the listing. **Loved it?** A quick review helps other teachers find it. **Something off?** Ask on the listing before reviewing — we fix fast.